



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*mokṣo viṣayavairasyaṃ bandho vaiṣayiko rasaḥ |
etāvadeva vijñānaṃ yathecchasi tathā kuru || 15 | 2 | |
vāgmiprājñamahodyogaṃ janaṃ mūkajaḍālasam |
karoti tattvabodho+ayamatastyakto bubhukṣubhiḥ || 15 | 3 | |*

— Aṣṭāvakragītā, Prakaraṇa 15 (Chapter 15), Verses 2-3

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Liberation, the Aṣṭāvakragītā teaches us, is born of detachment from sensory cravings, while bondage stems from clinging to the fleeting pleasures they offer. This, in its entirety, is the essential understanding, the pivotal wisdom: do as you will. This isn't a license for hedonism, but a profound invitation to conscious choice. Knowing the nature of freedom and bondage, you are empowered to navigate life with awareness. Will you choose the ephemeral thrill of attachment, or the enduring peace of detachment? The choice, and its consequences, rest solely with you.

This profound realization, this direct experience of truth, has a curious effect on individuals. It can transform the eloquent, the intelligent, and the industrious into seeming mutes, simpletons, or idlers. This isn't a diminishment, but a shift in priorities. The pursuit of external validation, the ceaseless striving, loses its allure when you glimpse the infinite contentment within. The activities and achievements that once defined you may seem less compelling in the light of self-realization. This truth, however, is often shunned by those still driven by worldly desires, by those who are hungry for recognition and material gain. They cling to their ambitions, fearing that self-knowledge will extinguish their drive.

How does this apply to your life today? In a world obsessed with achievement and sensory gratification, these verses offer a radical alternative. You are constantly bombarded with messages telling you what you need to be happy: a better job, a bigger house, more likes on social media. The Aṣṭāvakragītā challenges you to question these desires, to examine whether they truly lead to lasting fulfillment or merely perpetuate a cycle of craving and dissatisfaction. By cultivating detachment from these external pursuits, you can discover a deeper, more authentic sense of peace and freedom within yourself. The wisdom encourages you to be present and discerning, to make choices aligned with your true nature, rather than driven by societal pressures or fleeting desires. It's about living intentionally, knowing the difference between true liberation and the illusion of happiness.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Can you identify one area in your life where you are clinging to a desire that is causing you suffering, and what small step can you take today towards detachment?